



STANDARDS AND PROCEDURES

How we work: culture, standards, and the job from first call to final walkthrough

The way Premier Shade Solutions treats customers, their homes, and each other, written down so every job gets the same care. When we hire, this is the training manual.

Adopted September 10, 2026 · Reviewed every quarter with the business plan

1 hr Longest a new lead waits for a call back during business hours	24 hr Longest a written quote takes after the home visit	Same day A customer hears about any delay, problem, or change	Zero Remakes caused by our measurement or our order
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WHO WE ARE

The owners do the work

Most customers in this valley have met the window treatment salesperson who measures, sells, and disappears, leaving an installer they have never met. We are the opposite. The people who walk through the door for the consultation are the people who measure, order, install, and answer the phone afterward. Everything in this manual protects that promise.

Our values

VALUE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ON A JOB
Treat the home like our own	Shoe covers on, drop cloths down, nothing moved without asking, and the room cleaner when we leave than when we arrived.

VALUE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ON A JOB
Say it straight	Honest lead times, honest prices, and honest advice, even when the honest answer is the cheaper product or no product at all.
Never go quiet	The customer should never have to call us to find out what is happening. We tell them first, especially when the news is bad.
Measure twice, order once	Precision is the whole craft. A remake costs us the product, a second visit, and the customer's patience.
Fix it first, sort out blame later	When something goes wrong, the customer's problem gets solved before we work out whose fault it was.
Earn the referral	Every job is judged by one question: would this customer send us to their neighbor?

THE JOB, START TO FINISH

Eight stages, one owner at a time

Every job moves through the same stages as the job tracker. Each stage has a deadline and something the customer hears from us. Update the tracker the moment a job changes stage, from the phone if you are in the field, so either of us can pick up any job cold.

STAGE	WHAT WE DO	DEADLINE	WHAT THE CUSTOMER HEARS
New lead	Call. If no answer, leave a voicemail and send a text in the same minute.	1 hour	A real person, by name, offering visit times.
Contacted	Book the visit. Ask which rooms, what's bothering them (heat, glare, privacy, looks), and any budget they volunteer.	2 days	A text confirming date, time, and who is coming.
Visit booked	Reminder the day before. Pack the three sample kits and the measurement sheet.	Day before	"See you tomorrow at 10."
Quoted	Good, better, best quote, in writing, with motorization where it fits. Follow up if we hear nothing.	24 hr, then 48 hr follow-up	The quote, plus one call to answer questions.

STAGE	WHAT WE DO	DEADLINE	WHAT THE CUSTOMER HEARS
Sold	Signed quote and 50% deposit. Second owner checks the measurement sheet before anything is ordered.	Order within 2 business days	A thank-you and the expected install window.
Ordered	Place the vendor order, record the vendor's ship date, inspect product the day it arrives.	Inspect on arrival	"Your order is in," then an update whenever the date moves.
Installed	Install to the standard below, collect the balance, take photos, ask for the review in person.	Review text next day	A walkthrough, a care guide, and the review link.
Lost	Record the honest reason. Send one polite, no-pressure check-in 30 days later.	Within a week of going quiet	"Thanks for having us out. We're here if anything changes."

CLIENT COMMUNICATION

How we talk to customers

Most bad reviews in this trade are not about the blinds. They are about silence, missed arrival times, and surprises on the invoice. Our communication standard removes all three.

Response times

SITUATION	STANDARD
New lead, Monday to Saturday, 8am to 6pm	Called within 1 hour
New lead after hours or Sunday	Text acknowledgment the same evening, call by 9am the next business day
Existing customer call, text, or email	Answered the same business day
Problem or complaint	Acknowledged within 2 hours, visit offered within 3 business days
Vendor delay or any change to a date	Customer told the same day we learn of it

Rules of the road

- **Use the business line and business email**
(support@premiershadesolutions.com) for every customer conversation, so either of us can see the history.
- **Introduce yourself by name**, every time. We are two people, not a call center.
- **Confirm in writing** anything that involves a date, a price, or a change. A text is fine. "As we discussed" protects both sides.
- **Give arrival windows, not guesses.** A one-hour window, and a text when we're 20 minutes out. Running late by even 10 minutes means a call before the window starts, not after.
- **No jargon, no pressure.** Explain options in the customer's words: heat, glare, privacy, cleaning, kids and pets. Never push a close at the table, and never make a price "good for today only."
- **Bad news goes by phone.** Delays, damage, and mistakes get a call, followed by a text with the new plan. Good news can go by text.
- **Log every conversation** as a note on the job in the tracker: what was said and what we promised.

Standard messages

Adapt the words, keep the substance. Each message says who we are, what's next, and when.

MOMENT	MESSAGE
First reply to a lead	"Hi [name], this is [owner] with Premier Shade Solutions. Thanks for reaching out about your [rooms]. I have openings [two options] for a free in-home visit. Which works best?"
Visit confirmation	"You're set for [day] at [time]. [Owner] will bring samples from all three of our lines. It takes about an hour, and there's no cost or obligation."
Day-before reminder	"Looking forward to tomorrow at [time]. If anything changes, just reply here."
On the way	"On my way, about 20 minutes out."

Quote sent	"Your quote is attached with three options for the same windows. I'll check in on [day] to answer any questions."
Order placed	"Your order is in with [brand]. Their current lead time puts your install around [week]. I'll confirm the exact date as soon as it ships."
Delay	Call first. Then: "As we discussed, [brand] has moved your ship date to [date]. Your new install date is [date]. I'm sorry for the wait."
Install reminder	"We'll be there [day] between [window]. Please clear about three feet in front of each window if you can. We'll take care of the rest."
Day after install	"Thanks again for choosing us. If you have a minute, a Google review helps a small business like ours more than anything: [link]. And if anything isn't working perfectly, tell me first."

THE HOME VISIT

The consultation standard

The consultation is free and has no strings, as the website promises. Its job is to understand the home, measure it exactly, and leave the customer with three clear choices.

What comes in the car

- Sample kits from Superior Blinds MFG, Alta Window Fashions, and Hunter Douglas, including a motorized demo shade
- Steel tape measure, laser measure, step ladder, flashlight, and a depth gauge
- Our standard measurement sheet, and a phone charged for photos
- Shoe covers, business cards, and a door hanger for the neighbors

How the visit runs

1. **Listen first.** Ask what isn't working before showing anything. Heat, glare, privacy, sleep, looks, cords and kids.

2. **Walk every room on the list** and note which way each window faces.
West and south glass is where motorization and solar fabrics earn their keep.
3. **Measure every window** to the measurement standard below, and photograph each opening.
4. **Show three tiers** for the same windows: good, better, best. Put samples in the customer's hands, at the actual window.
5. **Offer motorization** on any window that's hard to reach or faces the afternoon sun, as its own line on the quote.
6. **Set expectations before leaving:** when the written quote arrives, the lead time for each tier, and how the 50% deposit works.

MEASURING AND ORDERING

Measure twice, order once

A remake is the most expensive mistake this business can make. It costs the product, a second install visit, weeks of the customer's time, and often the review. So the measurement and the order each get checked by both of us.

The measurement standard

- **One sheet, every job.** Room, window number, mount type, width, height, depth, and notes. No measurements on scrap paper or in memory.
- **To the nearest 1/8 inch**, with a steel tape. The laser is for ceilings and tall windows, not for the final width.
- **Inside mounts:** width at top, middle, and bottom, and order to the smallest. Height at left, center, and right, and order to the largest. Check depth for the product being quoted.
- **Outside mounts:** record the overlap on each side and the mounting surface above.
- **Note every obstruction:** cranks, handles, alarm sensors, vents, tile returns, out-of-square openings, and where the outlet is for motorized shades.

- **Both of us measure** anything unusual: openings over 72 inches wide, specialty shapes, shutters, exterior products, and motorized banks.

Before any order is placed

- ☐ The second owner has checked the order form line by line against the measurement sheet
- ☐ Mount type, color, fabric, control side, and lift type match the signed quote
- ☐ The customer has seen and approved the order summary in writing
- ☐ The 50% deposit is in the business account
- ☐ Vendor, order number, and expected ship date are recorded in the tracker

When product arrives

Open and inspect every box within 2 business days of arrival, not on installation morning. Check the count, sizes, colors, and damage against the order. A problem found in the garage is a phone call to the vendor. A problem found in the customer's living room is a second trip and a disappointed customer.

INSTALLATION DAY

The install standard

Installation day is what the customer remembers and what they write the review about. It should feel calm, clean, and finished.

Expectations we set with the customer

- A one-hour arrival window, confirmed the day before, and a text when we're on the way.
- A realistic time on site: roughly 20 to 30 minutes per blind or shade, longer for shutters and motorized banks. We tell them the estimate up front.
- They clear small items from sills and about three feet in front of each window if they can. We move furniture only with their permission, and we put it back.

- An adult is home for the final walkthrough and the balance payment.

Our standard on site

- **Presentation:** clean company shirts, shoe covers or indoor-only shoes, a clean vehicle, and the magnet or sign on it.
- **Protect the home:** drop cloth under every window we drill at, and a vacuum run after each room, not just at the end.
- **Before drilling:** check for wiring, plumbing, and alarm lines. Use the right anchor for the wall, and never mount into drywall alone on anything heavy or motorized.
- **Every product level, square, and secure.** Brackets screwed tight, headrails and valances level, shutters swinging freely and closing flush.
- **Every product tested** through its full range at least twice. Cords and wands meet child-safety standards, with tie-downs installed where required.
- **Motorized products paired and set up:** remotes labeled by room, the app installed on the customer's phone, and any schedules they want programmed before we leave.
- **Take everything with us.** Boxes, packaging, offcuts, and old blinds, unless the customer asks to keep them.

The final walkthrough

- ☐ Show the customer how every product operates, room by room, and let them try it
- ☐ Hand over the care guide and the warranty details for each brand
- ☐ Ask directly: "Is there anything you're not completely happy with?"
Fix what we can on the spot
- ☐ Collect the balance, and send the receipt before we leave the driveway
- ☐ Take after photos, and ask permission before using any of them in our gallery
- ☐ Ask for the Google review in person, and mention the \$100 referral reward

- ☐ Leave 20 to 30 door hangers on the neighboring streets
- ☐ Mark the job Installed in the tracker, with photos and notes

Summer heat rule

From June through September, exterior and attic-adjacent work is scheduled for the morning. No one works a Las Vegas afternoon outside without water, shade breaks, and a partner who knows where they are.

WHEN THINGS GO WRONG

Problems, remakes, and service calls

Every business in this trade gets a wrong size, a damaged slat, or a shade that stops working. Customers forgive the problem. They don't forgive being ignored while it gets fixed.

1. **Acknowledge within 2 hours.** Thank them for telling us, and don't argue about fault on the phone.
2. **See it within 3 business days.** Photos by text are fine for a first look, but we go look in person.
3. **Give a plan and a date in writing:** what we'll do, who pays, and when it will be done.
4. **Our mistake, our cost.** If we measured, ordered, or installed it wrong, we remake or repair it at no cost to the customer. Workmanship is guaranteed for one year from installation.
5. **Vendor defects go through the warranty,** but we handle the claim, the reinstall, and the updates. The customer deals with us, never with the factory.
6. **Log it and learn from it.** Every remake gets a note in the tracker with its cause, and we review remakes on Monday.

MONEY

How we handle payment

- **The consultation and quote are free.** No deposit to book a visit.

- **50% deposit when the order is placed**, balance on installation day.
Nothing is ordered before the deposit clears.
- **Written quotes only.** Every price is on a signed quote before work starts, and changes after ordering get a written change order signed before we act on it.
- **No surprise charges.** If something on site would add cost, such as extra blocking or an outlet for a motor, the customer approves it in writing first.
- **Every dollar goes through the business account**, with a receipt for every payment, card, check, or transfer.
- **Deposits are tracked separately** from earned revenue in the books until the job is installed.

WORKING TOGETHER

How the two of us run the business

- **Monday scorecard.** Ten minutes, the seven numbers from the business plan, plus any remakes, complaints, and stuck jobs from the tracker.
- **One owner per job.** Each job in the tracker has a lead owner who makes sure nothing stalls. The other can step in anytime, because the notes are complete.
- **Both of us agree** before any single expense over \$500, any new vendor or partner arrangement, any refund, and any change to prices or these standards.
- **Disagree in private, present as one.** A customer never sees us argue or contradict each other on price, dates, or advice.
- **Safety is not optional.** Ladders on stable ground, eye protection when drilling overhead, and the tools we'd want an employee to use.
- **Protect the time off.** Sunday is closed. Customer messages that arrive then get a reply Monday, except real emergencies.

When we hire

The plan brings on a part-time install helper once we're steadily above six jobs a month. Anyone who works for us learns this manual first, rides along on at least five installs before working alone, and is held to the same standards we hold ourselves to. When they meet a customer, they're Premier Shade Solutions.